



PEPPERDINE students with the Franklin fire in the distance. About 3:30 a.m. Tuesday, the university said the blaze had mostly passed.

Blaze burns a path through Malibu

Wind-fanned fire triggers evacuations but destroys ‘minimal number’ of homes.

By RICHARD WINTON, RUBEN VIVES, KAREN GARCIA, MATT HAMILTON AND HANNAH FRY

A ferocious wildfire fanned by strong winds burned through Malibu on Tuesday, destroying homes, triggering power outages and forcing thousands to evacuate along the coast in the dark while firefighters struggled to contain the flames.

The eastern half of Malibu remained under an evacuation order Tuesday. The rest of the city and some unincorporated areas of Los Angeles County were under an evacuation warning affecting about 18,000 people.

The blaze, dubbed the Franklin fire, was reported a few minutes before 11 p.m. Monday along Malibu Canyon Road in the hills north of Pepperdine University. Fanned by strong Santa Ana winds, the blaze moved at a fierce pace, exploding to more than 2,700 acres as of Tuesday afternoon with no containment, according to the California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection.

Los Angeles County Fire Chief Anthony Marrone said during a news conference Tuesday morning that a “minimal number” of homes had been destroyed, though he did not have an exact count of structures damaged. He urged residents to limit the use of lawn sprinklers to maintain water pressure for firefighters.

More than 800 firefighters battled the blaze on the ground Tuesday, building containment lines as aircraft dropped water and retardant on the flames. Helicopters were able to fly through the night and into the early morning Tuesday even amid heavy winds, Marrone said.

“We are going to have a coordinated air and ground assault on this fire for as long as it takes,” he said.

The blaze jumped Pacific Coast Highway in the early morning hours and continued toward the city’s historic pier, which officials said was not damaged. A sheriff’s patrol car was destroyed in the fire, but the deputy driving it was not hurt.

Some residents were able to start assessing the damage in the light of day Tuesday.

Past the security gates of Serra Retreat is a small enclave of luxury properties that’s home to celebrities such as Patrick Dempsey, Dick Van Dyke and at one time Mel Gibson. Overnight, the fire caught many in the area by surprise. Pets were killed and several cars and homes burned, including one on Mariposa De Oro Street, residents say.

Van Dyke wrote on Facebook that he and his wife, Arlene Silver, evacuated from their home.

“Arlene and I have safely evacuated with our animals except for Bobo escaped as we were leaving,” he wrote, referring to his cat. “We’re praying he’ll be ok and that our community in Serra Retreat will survive these terrors.”

Coastal community may have caught a break

Winds ease in the area often in the path of Santa Anas that drive blazes to the ocean

By GRACE TOOHEY, NATHAN SOLIS AND RONG-GONG LIN II

The conditions late Monday were primed for an explosive wildfire. Forecasters had issued a rare, particularly dangerous fire weather warning across much of Southern California, as strong Santa Ana winds were expected to further dry an already parched landscape. So when the Franklin fire broke out in Malibu on Monday night, it had the making of a real disaster. Malibu is one of the most fire-prone parts of Southern California, often in the path of Santa Ana winds that drive blazes marching to the Pacific Ocean.

But this time, the coastal city appears to have caught a break. The winds eased by Tuesday afternoon and didn’t reach historic speeds. That allowed an aerial assault on the fire from planes and helicopters that officials say helped save homes. The location of the fire not far from the ocean also minimized space for the blaze to grow. Although Malibu isn’t out of the danger zone, property damage has been reported as moderate and no major injuries were reported. That is a marked contrast from some destructive fires to hit the region in recent years.

[See Malibu, A6]



A PLANE drops retardant on the Franklin fire over Malibu Canyon. The blaze was at about 2,700 acres Tuesday afternoon.



A MURAL in Pico-Robertson depicts a woman lighting candles for Shabbat. Donald Trump won more votes in the area this year than in 2016 and 2020 combined.

TRUMP’S L.A. GAINS

Voters in Pico-Robertson are swayed by war, antisemitism

Many residents of the once strongly liberal Jewish neighborhood ‘want a change.’

By JACK FLEMMING

In 2020, the Jewish haven of Pico-Robertson voted for Joe Biden over Donald Trump, taking its place among the large swath of liberal Westside communities.

But in these politically fraught times, a lot can change in four years. A red tide washed through the neighborhood in recent months, and Trump drew more votes in Pico-Robertson than the previous two elections combined. Locals attribute the shifting dynamics to the Israel-Hamas war, rising instances of antisemitism and a strong Republican canvassing effort. Over the last eight years, Trump has slowly gained

ground in Pico-Robertson. The numbers aren’t exact, because voter precincts change boundaries and take in parts of surrounding neighborhoods such as Beverlywood and Crestview, but data show that Trump has gained thousands of votes over the course of the last three elections. In 2016, Trump took in 1,292 votes to Hillary Clinton’s 3,632. Four years later, Trump drew 2,693 to Biden’s 5,252. In 2024, Trump surged [See Pico-Robertson, A9]

Justices may sharply limit environmental impact statements

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court may be about to sharply limit the reach of so-called environmental impact statements, which gauge potential harm of proposed developments and often cause projects to be blocked or scaled back. For more than 50 years, federal law has required agencies to take a hard and broad look at the “reasonably foreseeable environmental effects” of a building or development project before approving it. The justices sounded ready on Tuesday to reconsider that approach in a case involving a proposed 88-mile railroad line in Utah that would allow crude oil to be shipped to refineries on the Gulf Coast. Washington attorney Paul Clement said in court that these impact assessments should focus narrowly on the project itself, not on its wider effects. He urged the justices to reject potential secondary effects that are “remote in time and place.” In their comments and questions, most of the justices appeared to agree. If so, their ruling could rein in the reach of environmental impact statements.

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